

Job titles lag the work.

We analyzed **47,101 Fortune 500 software job postings** and found the new roles forming inside the org chart — before anyone has agreed what to call them.

A cross-sectional study of US Fortune 500 software hiring · Cory Hymel, Head of Research, Andela

47,101

F500 POSTINGS ANALYZED

2,026

SKILLS SCORED & PLACED

23

EMERGENT-ROLE CANDIDATES

96%

JUDGED NON-ARTIFACT IN AUDIT

FOUR FINDINGS

- One role is unmistakably new.** The **MLOps Pipeline Engineer** — who builds the automated infrastructure that takes ML models to production — scores highest on emergence, bridging ML engineering, DevOps, and data engineering across 1,582 postings with no settled job title yet.
- Employers name the old role, hire the new one.** Among postings still titled for a familiar role like “AI Engineer” or “data scientist,” **53% already demand a newer skill set:** large language models combined with RAG, conversational AI, and tools like LangChain and the OpenAI API.
- New roles form in the seams.** Every detected bundle bridges two or more established roles by construction — from GitOps platform security to lakehouse analytics to FinOps reliability. The work is recombining faster than job architectures can track it.
- The signal is validated.** Tests were pre-registered before reading the results: the detector independently rediscovered five of the seven roles known to have emerged through skill bleed (DevSecOps, MLOps, Platform Engineer and more), and 96% of candidates passed a manual audit.

#1 EMERGENT ROLE

MLOps Pipeline Engineer

TOP EMERGENCE SCORE · 1,582 POSTINGS

Orchestrated pipelines, CI/CD for ML, model registries and versioning, ML observability. Bridges ML engineering, DevOps, and data engineering — a coherent, recurring skill bundle still maturing into a settled title across enterprises.

53%

of postings titled “AI Engineer” or “data scientist” already demand the emerging LLM stack. Your job architecture is describing work that has already changed.

THE EMERGENCE LANDSCAPE — TOP 5 OF 23, BY EMERGENCE SCORE

MLOps Pipeline Engineer		0.244	1,582 POSTINGS
GitOps Platform Security Engineer		0.200	2,608 POSTINGS
LLM Application Engineer		0.178	6,758 POSTINGS
FinOps Reliability Engineer		0.156	1,839 POSTINGS
Governed BI Engineer		0.156	1,314 POSTINGS

WHY IT MATTERS

Headcount plans, comp bands, and hiring specs built on job titles are already stale. As skill half-lives compress from roughly a decade to about two years, tomorrow's **talent debt** accrues in the seams between today's jobs. The advantage goes to enterprises that read their workforce by skills, not titles — and reskill ahead of the market.

ACT ON THE DATA WITH ANDELA

Andela reads the technology talent market by its skills, not its titles — continuous assessment and always-on upskilling across a 5.6M-technoloaist ecosvstem.

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